



1688

“GLORIOUS REVOLUTION” IN BRITAIN

The succession of James II in 1685 caused a crisis in Britain because he was a Catholic and keen to rule without parliament. The political elite decided to replace him. Dutch leader William of Orange, a Protestant married to James’s daughter Mary, was invited to take the throne as William III. He landed in England unopposed and James fled into exile. This “Glorious Revolution” confirmed Britain as a Protestant parliamentary state.

◁ Carpet showing the arms of William III

1689 The Grand Alliance

of England, the Netherlands, and Austria is formed against Louis XIV of France

1689

1689 The Treaty of Nerchinsk

settles the border between China and Russia along the Amur River and Lake Baikal, opening trade across Siberia

1688

SIAMESE COUP

In the 1680s, the Ayutthaya kingdom in Siam (modern-day Thailand) had extensive contact with Europeans. Its king, Naria, sent diplomats to the court of Louis XIV and welcomed French traders, soldiers, and missionaries. In 1688, Siamese nationalists opposed to foreign influence overthrew Naria in a palace coup. The French were expelled and all contacts with Europeans curtailed.

▷ View of Ayutthaya city, c. 1665

